

第六单元 公司发展

6.1 Site Location and Relocation

公司选址和迁址

6.1.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

excess capacity 过剩生产能力

dictate *vt.* 命令, 强制规定

economy of cost 成本经济

in line with 符合, 与……一致

ample *adj.* 宽敞的, 宽大的; 大量的, 充裕的amenable *adj.* 顺从的, 积极响应的

day care 日托

corporate tax 企业税

work ethic 职业道德观

weighted center of demand (某产品)
需求量很大的地方sizable *adj.* 相当大的materials-oriented location 靠近原料地
的场所market-oriented location 靠近市场的
场所appeal *n.* 吸引力

6.1.2 Background Information (相关背景知识)

选址和迁址

选址是公司的一个重要策略, 影响到一个公司的竞争能力以及公司经营的许多方面。在制造业, 选址影响运输成本、劳动力成本和生产过程中所使用原料的成本; 在服务业, 选址影响到对服务的需求和整个经营的有效性。无论是生产还是非生产场所的选择对运营成本都有很大的影响, 并影响到利润、产品或服务的价格。选址还会影响到员工的士气、员工之间的关系, 以及公共关系。

选址的效果是隐伏的, 一旦作出不明智的选址决策, 其代价是惨重的, 后果是持久的, 因而管理人员必须十分警惕, 要对所选的地址进行详细认真的评估。不明

智的选址会使机会丧失，而且其后果表面上是看不出来的。财务报告没有体现丧失机会所造成的损失，只有对经营进行定期检查和评估的人员才会注意到这些损失。

许多公司不止一次面临选址的决定。一个新公司刚开始也许在一个租赁的地方进行经营，然后决定自己建造或购买经营场所，随着公司的不断扩大，公司的经营场所也随之增加到多处。经营场所需求的变化和新产品或服务的增加，也会促使公司迁移经营场所。此外，如果公司在某个经营场所生产能力过剩或运输成本过大，公司也会作出迁址的决定。

6.1.3 Background Reading（相关背景阅读）

Site Selection

When a company starts up or opens a new branch, the production and operations manager is heavily involved in planning the site location. The type of business dictates the kind of facility. Service sector businesses will often require small office facilities in heavy traffic areas convenient to customers and other services the business itself requires. Heavy industry, on the other hand, requires vast space near ship or rail transportation, often beside bodies of water that can be used for cooling operations as well as transportation to market. Most if not all of the factors in the following list will be considered in the production and operations manager's plan for site location.

- Economies of cost or other economic advantages for land, buildings or units, taxes, insurance, and so on.
- Nearness to related industries and suppliers, warehouses, or service operations.
- Location of competitors.
- Availability of appropriate labor force, considering such factors as quality or low cost.
- Availability of economical transportation for materials and supplies as well as for finished goods.
- Nearness to market for goods.
- Air and water conditions.
- Nearness to plentiful and economical energy, sources.
- Climate and environment in line with needs for the kind of industry and amenable for employees' lifestyle.
- Ample space for planned needs of business and for later expansion.
- Nearness to such employee needs as housing, school, transportation, religious

facilities, day care, shopping, and recreational facilities.

- Community receptiveness.

参考译文

选 址

当公司打算开设一个新的分公司时, 生产经营部的经理就得忙于分公司的选址问题了。经营的类型决定了所选的地址。服务行业一般要求在空间较小但必须是交通流量大、便于顾客的地方, 或是在靠近它所需要的其他服务行业的地方。而重工业却要求地域广阔且靠近轮船或铁路运输的地方, 它们经常是选在靠近大片水域的地方, 因为大片水域既可以用于设备冷却, 又可以用于产品运输。生产经营部的经理在考虑厂址时, 通常要考虑以下列出的大部分因素, 但可能不是全部的因素。

- 成本经济以及有经济优势的土地、楼房或单元、税收、保险等。
- 靠近相关的产业和供货商, 仓库或服务行业。
- 竞争者的位置。
- 存在劳动力的地方, 并且要考虑诸如劳动力素质和是否低成本的因素。
- 生产材料和设备以及成品运输成本较低的地方。
- 靠近公司产品市场的地方。
- 空气状况和水源条件较好的地方。
- 靠近经济实惠且储量巨大的能源。
- 气候和环境符合企业的需要, 并适合员工的生活方式。
- 要有能容纳企业将来发展和扩大需要的足够大的地盘。
- 照顾员工的需求, 靠近住房、学校、交通、教堂、日托、商店以及有娱乐设施的地方。
- 社区能接受该企业的地方。

6.1.4 Sample Test (□试样例)

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

- (1) Why do companies relocate to another country?

为什么有些公司要迁到另一个国家?

- (2) How does a good location add value for customers?

一个好的公司地址是如何为顾客提供更高的价值的?

- (3) Do you think the location of competitors will affect the location of a company?
(Why? /Why not?)

你认为竞争者所处的位置会影响一个公司的选址吗? (为什么?)

- (4) Do you think taxes affect the selection of a company's location? (Why? /Why not?)

你认为税收会影响公司的选址吗? (为什么?)

Suggested answers

- (1) They relocate to another country to get closer to the market.

(They relocate to another country because of cheaper labor costs/low rates of corporate tax.)

(They relocate to another country when they have excess capacity in one location or excess shipping cost in some areas.)

(Shifts in the location demand and the addition of new products or services to those already offered may necessitate relocation.)

- (2) It enables a company to provide convenient, dependable service to its customers. Locating in areas where there are sufficient skilled or trained workers with a good work ethic can lead to higher-quality performance.

- (3) Yes, competition is also an important factor in site selection. Some companies consider it necessary to be located near competition, others wish to avoid competitors.

- (4) Yes, because taxes may be sizable for a company with a multimillion-dollar investment in facilities and inventory, so it may select a location where tax reductions or exemptions are allowed to new business.
-

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What is important when...?

选择公司地址时应注意什么要点?

Selecting a company location

- demand for products or services
- transportation
-

- 产品或服务的需求
- 运输
-

Suggested answer

When choosing a company location, I think the company should first take into account the demand for products or services, both now and in the future. Demand forecasts help determine where goods or services are most likely to be sold. A weighted center of de-

mand exists for each product or product family, so a company should select a location which supplies this demand.

Transportation is also important when selecting a company location. A manufacturing company will tend to have a materials-oriented location if it has a single source of raw material and ships its products to many destinations. When rapid delivery is a condition of sales, companies are more likely to select market-oriented locations, that is to locate near consumers.

In addition, I think it's important to consider labor costs. Companies that employ a large labor force may locate to places with lower wage rates. Productivity per hour may further affect the costs of providing services or producing goods.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Site Selection

The law firm you work for decides to relocate to a new place. You have been asked to choose a good location. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what factors should be considered
- what are the advantages of a good location for the law firm

选 址

你们工作的律师事务所决定搬到一个新的地方。事务所请你们选一个好的场所。讨论并决定:

- 应该考虑什么因素
- 好的地址对律师事务所有什么好处

Suggested answer

- A: Since we provide law services, our firm should be located in a well-established and fast-growing business area, because in such an area, there are many businesses which will need law services.
- B: I'm with you on that. We must locate in a place where there is high level of demand for services. And the public transportation is very convenient in such an area. Customers will find it easy to get to us.
- A: Yes, as you know, the convenience or inconvenience of a location may affect the number of potential customers and thus revenue.
- B: Are there any other factors to consider?
- A: I think we should consider the leasing rents. The leasing rents vary from place to

place. We of course should select a site which we can afford.

B: That's true. I think we should also consider competition. We shouldn't locate in a place where there are already a lot of law firms.

A: I couldn't agree with you more. Competition may severely affect a company's revenue.

B: We should consider expansion potential. Our firm may employ many lawyers one day when it expands, so we should leave some room for expansion.

A: And I also think we should consider the appeal of the location. People are interested in the environment in which they work and live.

B: Now, let's talk about advantages of a good location for a law firm. A good location is likely to attract customers. If our firm is located in a good location, the number of customers will surely go up.

A: Yeah, being located in a place with high demand will boost our business, thus increasing the company's profits.

B: A good location with easy access to public transport enables our law firm to provide high value for customers.

A: Yeah, and we can avoid competition if located in a place with few law firms. Otherwise, our law firm may lose some or even much of our business.

A: In addition, our law firm can save costs if it is located in a place with low leasing rents. Lower leasing rents also make it possible for our law firm to have more office space, which will offer some flexibility and room for the expansion of our law firm.

Follow-up questions

(1) Do you think construction costs will affect a company in selecting a location? (Why? /Why not?)

你认为建筑成本会影响公司的选址吗? (为什么?)

(2) Will you consider company expansion potential when you are selecting a location? (Why? /Why not?)

当你选择公司的地址时, 你会考虑公司将来的发展需求吗? (为什么?)

(3) Will you consider community attitudes when selecting a company location? (Why? /Why not?)

选择公司地址时, 你会考虑社区对公司的态度吗? (为什么?)

(4) What factors do you think a retail shop should consider when selecting its location?

你认为选择零售商店地址时, 应考虑什么因素?

- (5) Do you think the effects of a poor location decision are directly observable?
(Why? /Why not?)

你认为不明智的选址决定所导致的后果一眼就能看得出来吗? (为什么?)

Suggested answers

(1) Yes. Because the costs of purchasing the site and building the facilities are directly related to a company's location. The cost of per acre of land varies widely from site to site within a region and from region to region.

(2) I will. I think the site for a manufacturing or nonmanufacturing companies should offer some flexibility and room for expansion.

(3) I will, because public opinion in some areas may be unfavorable to a particular type of business. A company located in such an area runs the risk of future restriction, excessive taxes, or other undesirable public relations.

(4) The types and nearness of competing stores, traffic, convenience of the entrance and exit, nearness to public transportation, visibility of the shop, convenient and secure parking nearby, etc.

(5) No, they are not, because the cost of a poor location decision is an opportunity lost and therefore the effects are hidden.

6.2 Going Global

全球营销

6.2.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

barrier *n.* 壁垒

direct exporting 直接出口

direct investment 直接投资

distribution *n.* 分销

economies of scale 规模效益, 规模经济 (因经济规模扩大而得到的经济节约), 亦作 scale economies

embargo *n.* 禁止贸易令

exchange control 外汇管制

joint venture *n.* 合资企业

know-how *n.* 实际知识, 技术

licensing *n.* 许可合同交易

payoff *n.* 报偿, 价值

political unrest 政治动乱

product adaptation 产品适应

quota *n.* (贸易) 限额

royalty (royalty fee) *n.* 特许使用费

tariff *n.* 关税

tangible *adj.* 有形的，可触知的

trade restriction 贸易限制

terminate *vt.* 停止，结束，使终止

subsidiary *n.* 子公司

exchange rate （外汇）汇率，兑换率

local adaptation 为适应当地市场所做

的产品调整

marketing disaster 营销惨败

legal framework 法律体制

surplus *adj. & n.* 过剩的，剩余的；剩
余，过剩，盈余

6.2.2 Background Information（相关背景知识）

国际贸易

国际贸易（International Trade）是指不同国家（地区）之间的商品、服务和生产要素交换的活动，其具体表现在以下几方面：

（1）调节各国市场的供求关系。国际贸易不仅可以增加国内短缺产品的市场供给量，满足消费者的需求，而且还为各国国内市场的过剩产品提供了新的出路，在一定程度上缓解了市场供求的矛盾。

（2）促进生产要素的充分利用。在当今世界上，劳动力、资本、土地、技术等生产要素在各个国家的分布往往是不平衡的。通过国际贸易，这些国家就可以采取国际劳务贸易、资本转移、土地租赁、技术贸易等方式，用国内富余的生产要素与其他国家交换国内短缺的生产要素，从而使短缺生产要素的制约得以缓解或消除，富余生产要素得以充分利用，加速经济发展。

（3）发挥比较优势，提高生产效率。利用比较利益和比较优势进行国际分工和国际贸易，可以扩大优势商品生产，缩小劣势商品生产，并出口优势产品从国外换回本国居于劣势的商品，从而提高生产要素的效能，提高生产效率，获得更大的经济效益。

（4）提高生产技术水平，优化国内产业结构。在当今世界，各国普遍通过国际贸易引进先进的科学技术和设备，以提高国内的生产力水平，加快经济发展。同时，通过国际贸易，使国内的产业结构逐步协调和完善，促使整个国民经济协调发展。

6.2.3 Background Reading（相关背景阅读）

Barriers to International Business

Firms desiring to enter international business face several obstacles, some much more

severe than others. The most common barriers to effective business are cultural, social, and political barriers, and tariffs and trade restrictions.

Cultural and Social Barriers

A nation's culture and social forces can restrict international business activities. Culture consists of a country's general concepts and values and tangible items such as food, clothing, and building. Social forces include family, education, religion and customs. Selling products from one country to another is sometimes difficult when the cultures of the two countries differ significantly. For example, when McDonald's opened its first restaurant in Rome, it was met with protest. The people of Rome objected to the smell of hamburgers frying. McDonald's overcame this objection by changing the exhaust system of the restaurant.

Social forces can create obstacles to international trade. In some countries, purchasing items as basic as food and clothing can be influenced by religion. In many nations, individuals do not have the same choices in food, clothing, and health care.

Political Barriers

The political climate of a country can have a major impact on international business. Nations experiencing intense political unrest may change their attitude toward foreign firms at any time; this instability creates an unfavorable atmosphere for international trade.

Tariffs and Trade Restrictions

Tariffs and trade restrictions are also barriers to international business. A nation can restrict trade through import tariffs, quotas and embargoes, and exchange controls.

参考译文

影响国际贸易的壁垒

对希望进行国际贸易的公司来说,它们将面临一些障碍,其中有些障碍是相当巨大的。最常见的障碍是文化、社会和政治的壁垒,以及关税和贸易管制。

文化和社会壁垒

一个国家的文化和社会因素会影响到它的国家贸易活动。文化是指某个国家总的观念和价值观,以及诸如食物、衣着和建筑等有形物体。社会因素包括家庭、教育、宗教和风俗习惯。当两个国家的文化存在着巨大的差异时,把产品从

一个国家销往另一个国家有时是相当困难的。比如,麦当劳在罗马开首家餐厅时,它遭到了抗议。罗马人不喜欢制作汉堡所排放的气味,麦当劳通过改变排放系统改变了这种局面。

社会因素对国家贸易也会造成一些障碍。在一些国家,购买一些基本的东西如食物和服装都会受到宗教的影响。在许多国家,个人对食品、服装和保健品的选择往往是不同的。

政治壁垒

一个国家的政治气候对国家贸易往往有很大的影响,正经历急剧政治动乱的国家可能会随时改变其对外国公司的态度,这种政治不稳定对国际贸易是非常不利的。

关税和贸易限制

关税和贸易限制也是国际贸易的壁垒。一个国家可以通过进口关税、贸易限额、贸易禁运和外汇管制来限制国家贸易。

6.2.4 Sample Test (□试样例)

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

- (1) Why do you think companies do international business?
你认为公司进行国际贸易的原因是什么?
- (2) Do you think international business is important for a country? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为国际贸易对一个国家来说重要吗?(为什么?)
- (3) Do you think licensing will be the most popular way of entering foreign markets? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为许可合同贸易是进入国外市场最常用的方法吗?(为什么?)
- (4) Do you think joint-venture is an effective way of doing international business? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为合资企业是进行国际贸易有效的方法吗?(为什么?)

Suggested answers

(1) The reason companies do international business is to exploit a better business opportunity in terms of increased sales and profits.

(It is because foreign countries may have rich resources and may offer favorable tax and trade options.)

(I think companies do international business because competition in the foreign countries is not so intense as in their home country.)

(2) I think international business is important because it may create additional jobs and improve standard of living.

(3) I think so, because licensing requires no investment, the financial risk is the lowest compared to other ways of entering foreign markets. Companies can still gain royalty for allowing licensee to sell its products or using its brand names.

(No, I don't think so. Licensing is of low financial risk, but it has the risk of trade secrets being given away and licensor cannot keep close control of the product.)

(4) Yes, because in a typical joint venture, two companies can share some of the costs and risk, moreover, they can pool their know-how and learn from each other.

(No, because in a joint venture, organisations may lose control of their operations.)

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What is important when...?

第一次出口商品或服务时应注意什

Exporting goods or services for the

么要点?

first time

- legal framework
- cultural differences
-

- 法律体制
- 文化差异
-

Suggested answer

The company should try to be familiar with all those international-business-related laws, because in doing international business it must abide by the laws of its own nation, international laws, and the laws of the nation with which it will be trading.

What's more, the company should consider cultural differences. Culture differs from country to country. People in different countries have different tastes and needs for goods or services. The company should take these into consideration, so that it can cater to the tastes and needs of people in foreign countries. Otherwise, the goods or services won't sell well.

In addition, it's also important for the company to consider distribution methods. The company should compare all the available distribution methods and choose one which is the most convenient and cost-effective.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Entering Foreign Markets

Your company decides to enter foreign markets. You have been asked by your manager to plan for it. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what is the best way of entering foreign markets
- whether there exists the need of product adaptation.

进入国外市场

你们的公司决定进入国外市场。经理请你们负责筹划此事。讨论并决定:

- 该公司进入国外市场的最佳方法是什么
- 是否需要改变该公司的产品

Suggested answer

- A: I think the best way for our company to enter foreign markets is licensing. By licensing we can keep the financial risk to a minimum.
- B: That's true, but it doesn't result in a large payoff for our company, and the licensee may still continue to market the product without paying us after the agreement expires. To make matters worse, we may give away our trade secret by licensing.
- A: What about a joint venture? The foreign company will share the costs and risks with our company.
- B: But usually there are conflicts between the partners, in the end, the joint venture will be terminated.
- A: So, what do you think is the best way for our company to enter foreign markets?
- B: I think the best way is to set up a subsidiary. By setting up a subsidiary, we can save the shipping costs and keep complete control of the business.
- A: But it requires a large investment.
- B: But the marketing research shows that the demand for our product in foreign countries is high, we can gain a large payoff by economies of scale.
- A: It sounds reasonable. All right, we can set up a subsidiaries to enter foreign markets. Now let's consider whether our product needs adaptation. If we alter our product, we'll have to invest a lot of money.
- B: If we don't have to adapt our product, it will be great. But as shown in the marketing research, the needs of people in foreign countries are different from those of people at home. So in order to meet the needs in foreign markets, we have to

adapt our product even though the process is costly. But in the end, we can gain large profits which will far exceed the costs of adaptation.

A: That's true, if we don't adapt our product, we can save a lot of cost, but our product won't sell well.

B: So, now we can decide that our product needs adaptation in order to cater to the needs in foreign markets.

Follow-up questions

(1) What economic conditions in the foreign country do you think a company should consider when deciding to do international business?

决定进行国际贸易时, 公司要考虑外国的什么经济状况?

(2) Should promotion be modified when doing international business? (Why? / Why not?)

进行国际贸易时, 产品促销方式是否要进行调整? (为什么?)

(3) Will you use the same media for advertising or publicity when selling products in foreign markets? (Why? / Why not?)

在国外销售产品时, 你是否会使用与国内相同的媒体做广告或公共宣传吗? (为什么?)

(4) What do you think your company should do if your company cannot modify existing products to meet the needs of a foreign market?

如果你的公司无法对现在的产品进行调整以适应国外市场的需要, 你认为你公司应怎么做?

(5) Do you think exchange rate can affect international marketing? (Why? / Why not?)

你认为汇率会影响国际贸易吗? (为什么?)

Suggested answers

(1) I think the company should consider the country's stage of economic development, its economic infrastructure, consumer income and currency exchange rates.

(2) Yes, because language, laws, and culture differ from country to country.

(No, because uniform promotion enables companies to gain recognition throughout the world.)

(3) No, I will use different media in different countries. Some nations do not have commercial television. Others do not have advertising space in newspapers. The circulation of magazines and newspapers also varies greatly from one country to another.

(4) I think my company can either develop a completely new product for that country or try to sell the current product in that country.

(5) Yes, it can, because fluctuations in exchange rate can make a nation's currency more or less valuable compared to those of other nations.

6.3 Mergers and Acquisitions and Franchise

企业并购和特许经营

6.3.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

mergers and acquisitions 企业并购

franchise *n.* 特许经营

glaring *adj.* 耀眼的, 显眼的

managerial *adj.* 管理的

get by 通过, 混过

deficiency *n.* 不足, 欠缺

franchisee *n.* 被特许人

franchisor (franchiser) *n.* 特许人

franchise agreement 特许协议

franchise fee 许可证费

Holiday Inn 假日饭店

Pizza Hut 比萨饼店

start-up costs 启动费用

well-established *adj.* 建立起地位的,
得到确认的

credit rating 信誉度

duplicate *adj.* 复制的, 完全一样的

cross-sell *v.* 交叉销售

economy of scale 规模经济

horizontal integration 横向合并

down payment 定金, (分期付款的)
初付款项

compatible *adj.* 能共存的, 相容的

cultural clash 文化冲突

hurdle *n.* 障碍, 困难

hindrance *n.* 妨害, 障碍, 干扰

governance *n.* 管理

diseconomies of scale 规模不经济

potential customers 潜在客户

syrup *n.* 糖浆, 糖汁, 果子露

sign *n.* 招牌

6.3.2 Background Information (相关背景知识)

企业并购动因

企业并购包括兼并和收购。国际上习惯将兼并和收购合在一起使用, 统称为 M&A, 在我国称为并购。并购的动因, 归纳起来主要有以下几类:

(1) 扩大生产经营规模, 降低成本费用。通过并购, 企业规模得到扩大, 能

够形成有效的规模效应。规模效应能够带来资源的充分利用，资源的充分整合，降低管理、原料、生产等各个环节的成本，从而降低总成本。

(2) 提高市场份额，提升行业战略地位。规模大的企业，伴随生产力的提高，销售网络的完善，市场份额将会有比较大的提高，从而确立企业在行业中的领导地位。

(3) 取得充足廉价的生产原料和劳动力，增强企业的竞争力。通过并购实现企业的规模扩大，成为原料的主要客户，能够大大增强企业的谈判能力，从而为企业获得廉价的生产资料提供可能。同时，高效的管理、人力资源的充分利用和企业的知名度都有助于企业降低劳动力成本，从而提高企业的整体竞争力。

(4) 实施品牌经营战略，提高企业的知名度，以获取超额利润。品牌是价值的动力，同样的产品，甚至是同样的质量，名牌产品的价值远远高于普通产品。并购能够有效提高品牌知名度，提高企业产品的附加值，获得更多的利润。

6.3.3 Background Reading (相关背景阅读)

Advantages of Owning a Franchise

A person who has never owned or managed a business needs guidance to operate successfully. This guidance can be provided by a well-run franchise organization. Also, franchisers can provide a brand name, products or services, and financial assistance.

Guidance A glaring weakness in small businesses is the lack of managerial ability. A person with limited managerial skills may be able to get by in a large organization because he or she is just one of many managers. But no one can cover up or “carry” a franchise manager. Many franchisers try to overcome managerial deficiencies or inexperience by providing some form of training.

Brand name The investor who signs a franchise agreement acquires the right to use a certain brand name. This identifies the local unit with a recognized product or service. Travelers recognize the Holiday Inn sign and the colors of a Pizza Hut building. Promotion brings these features and characteristics to the attention of potential consumers.

Product The franchiser can offer the franchisee a proven product and methods of operating the business. The product or service is known and accepted by the public.

Financial assistance By joining a franchise company, the individual investor may be able to secure financial assistance. Start-up costs of any business are often high, and the prospective investor usually has limited funds. In some cases, association with a well-established franchisor—through its reputation—may enhance the investor’s credit rating with local banks.

参考译文

特许经营优势

对一个从未拥有或经营过企业的人来说，需要得到成功经营企业的指导。一个经营良好的特许企业可以提供这方面的指导。不仅如此，它还可以提供品牌、产品或服务，甚至财务方面的帮助。

获得指导。小企业一个很明显的缺陷是缺少经营管理能力。一个经营管理能力有限的人可以在大企业中混，因为他（她）仅仅是许多管理人员中的一位。但作为被特许企业的管理人员，他（她）在管理方面的缺陷就会暴露无遗。许多特许企业往往通过提供某种形式的培训尽力克服管理方面的欠缺或经验不足。

获得品牌。一旦签订了特许协议，投资者就获得了使用某一品牌名称的权利。这等同于当地的投资者可以使用某一知名的产品或服务。旅游者都认得假日饭店的招牌和比萨饼建筑的颜色，这是因为广告等促销活动使得潜在的顾客注意到了这些产品的特色和特征。

获得产品。特许企业可以提供给被特许人知名的产品或经营管理企业的方法，所提供的产品或服务是公众所知晓并能接受的。

获得财务帮助。加入一个特许经营的公司，投资者很有可能获得财务上的帮助。一个企业的启动成本往往是很高的，而投资者的资金往往又有限。在有些情况下，借助于一个已树立声誉的特许公司的名声，投资者可以提高其在当地银行的信誉度。

6.3.4 Sample Test （□试样例）

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

- (1) What kind of franchised business will you enter? (Why?)
你愿意经营哪一类的特许经营企业？（为什么？）
- (2) Why do you think people open a franchised business?
你认为人们为什么要经营特许企业？
- (3) What do you think are the major motives of mergers and acquisitions?
你认为并购的主要目的是什么？
- (4) What do you think are the advantages of mergers and acquisitions?
并购的好处有哪些？

Suggested answers

(1) I think I will choose food sector, because there are a lot of well-recognized fast food restaurants. I can use their brand names, which will make it easier to earn money.

(I will choose a clothing company. There is always a big market in clothing sector which will make your business profitable.)

(2) Because franchising enables many people to both own a business and get help running it.

(Franchises do not have to develop a new product, create a new company, or test the market.

Franchising offers businesses of all sizes a way to grow with minimum investment.)

(3) The combined company can reduce its costs by removing duplicate departments or operations, the company can increase revenue or market share, the company can cross-sell its products, etc.

(4) The advantages of mergers and acquisitions are: economies of scale, which reduces unit costs, and greater market share for horizontal integration, which often means the business can charge higher prices or reduce competition if a rival is taken over, etc.

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What is important when...?

考虑公司合并时要注意什么?

Considering a merger with another

company

- their product lines
- their company culture
-

- 产品范围
- 公司文化
-

Suggested answer

When considering a merger with another company, it's important to take their product range into account. If the two companies are in direct competition and share similar product lines, then the merger will avoid the competition, what's more, the duplicate cost in producing similar products can be lowered, as a result, the combined company will be consolidated and become more powerful.

The second factor in considering a merger, in my eyes, is to consider their company culture. If the two companies have completely different cultures, then, the cultural integration will be very difficult because there will be cultural clashes, consequently, it may lead to the failure of the merger.

The third factor is to consider their markets. If the two companies sell similar products in different market, then the merger will capture larger market share and increase revenue.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Ensuring the Success of a Merger

Your company has just merged with another company.

You have been asked to make recommendations on how the new company can be successful following the merger.

Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what difficulties the new company might be confronted with
- how to ensure the success of the new merger

确保合并公司成功

你们公司刚和另一个公司合并。

公司请你们就新公司如何在合并后能成功提出建议。讨论并决定:

- 公司将面临什么样的困难
- 如何确保新的合并公司成功

Suggested answer

A: In the process of merger, there will be certainly many difficulties the new company might be faced with.

B: Yes, that's true. I think the first difficulty will be the organizational integration: before the merger, the two companies had different business models. It will be very hard for the new organization to integrate two different models.

A: Apart from what you mentioned, technically speaking, the integration of information system, in my opinion, will also be difficult. With so large an amount of information to integrate, the process will probably be very tough.

B: What you said is quite right. And I think, the two companies have very different corporate cultures, though they are still compatible. There will probably be cultural clashes in the merger process. As revealed by studies done among thousands of mergers and acquisitions, cultural clash is a major hurdle that hampers the success of a new combined organization.

A: You're right. Now, let's think of some measures to ensure the success of our new company. In my eyes, to tackle those technical issues, the company may employ a lot of technical staff. Given this, technical issues won't pose any hindrance to

the success of the new merger.

B: On the other hand, the new company should not focus too intently on cutting costs following the merger, otherwise, revenues, and ultimately, profits will suffer.

B: Yes, I agree. Generally speaking, cost-cutting is the priority of the directors and managers at the beginning of the merger, you see, it's the primary motive for the merger.

A: Yes, while the company focuses on the integration process and cost-cutting, it should not ignore the cultural differences.

B: To solve the problem, the new company should set up a cross-section team of representatives from both organizations and develop a new mission based on mutual respect for both cultures.

A: That's true. Both organizations should respect each other, and the larger or stronger of the two organizations should not try to significantly influence the integration.

B: One more thing, the company should not neglect day-to-day business, thus nervous customers will not choose to flee.

Follow-up questions

- (1) Do you think governance of the new organization is of critical importance?
你认为合并后新企业的管理至关重要吗?
- (2) Do you think leadership for the new organization must be determined before the merger?
你认为合并后新企业的领导权应在合并前就先决定吗?
- (3) Do you think *merger* and *acquisition* refer to the same thing? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为兼并和收购是同一回事吗? (为什么?)
- (4) Do you think non-technical issues must be identified and addressed when management plans a merger or acquisition? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为管理人员在兼并或收购前就应确定并解决非技术性的问题吗? (为什么?)
- (5) What do you think are the disadvantages of mergers and acquisitions?
你认为兼并和收购的弊病有哪些?

Suggested answers

- (1) Yes, it is of critical importance. It must be discussed openly and negotiated. Which board of directors and which directors will survive the transaction must be de-

cided. Without solving this issue, the new organization will find it difficult to achieve success.

(2) Yes, delaying this issue usually results in power struggles among executives and management staffs, thus causing the failure of the new organization.

(3) I think they are different. A merger happens when two firms, often of about the same size, agree to go forward as a single new company rather than remain separately owned and operated. When one company takes over another and clearly establishes itself as the new owner, the purchase is called an acquisition.

(4) Yes, failure to do so causes problems when a merger or acquisition is implemented. By submerging the non-technical issues during the planning phase, an organization runs the greatest risk of all—not only being unsuccessful in implementing the merger or acquisition, but also weakening itself.

(5) The disadvantages of mergers and acquisitions are: diseconomies of scale if the business becomes too large; need to make some workers redundant, which may have negative effect on motivation; a conflict of objectives between different businesses, etc.

6.4 Meeting Competition

应对竞争

6.4.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

elastic *adj.* 有弹性的, 有弹力的 (需求未达到饱和, 具有伸缩性)

advisable *adj.* 可取的, 适当的, 明智的

direct competition 直接竞争

indirect competition 间接竞争

innovation *n.* 革新, 创新

differentiate *vi.* 使有差别, 区别

Ford 福特汽车公司 (美国)

Apple Computer 苹果电脑公司

Southwest Airlines 西南航空公司

Wal-Mart 沃尔玛公司 (美国大型连锁超市集团)

Motorola 摩托罗拉公司 (美国移动通信制造商)

experience curve 经验曲线 (生产效率随着经验的积累而上升)

sporty *adj.* (汽车) 竞赛车型的, (性能) 像竞赛车的

6.4.2 Background Information (相关背景知识)

企业竞争优势

所谓企业竞争优势,是指企业在产出规模、组织结构、劳动效率、品牌、产品质量、信誉、新产品开发以及管理和营销技术等方面所具有的各种有利条件。

20 世纪 90 年代中叶,美国信息技术战略家鲍尔 (Bernard H. Boar) 将企业的竞争优势归纳为五种类型:

- (1) 成本优势: 这种优势能够使企业提供更廉价的产品或服务。
- (2) 增值优势: 这种优势能够使企业创造出更吸引人的产品或服务。
- (3) 聚焦优势: 这种优势能够使企业更恰当地满足特定顾客群体的需求。
- (4) 速度优势: 这种优势能够使企业比竞争对手更及时地满足顾客的需求。
- (5) 机动优势: 这种优势能够使企业比竞争对手更快地适应变化的需求。

为了成功,一个企业组织必须获取和维持某种对其竞争者的优势。换言之,一个公司必须形成一种竞争优势或相对于其竞争者的优越市场位置。这种竞争优势的获得一般通过两种方式: 成本领先和产品分化。成本领先方式,即一个公司提供与其竞争者相同的服务或产品,但以一种较低的价格进行生产,以获得企业竞争优势。实现成本领先的途径和方法有多种,但通常通过提高生产率和降低生产成本来实现。其中,采用新技术或设计更有效率的工作方法可以提高生产率,减少一般管理成本和人工成本以降低生产成本。而产品分化的方法主要有四种: 创造一种比竞争者的质量更好的产品或服务,提供竞争者不提供的创新性的产品或服务,选择一个顾客更容易接近的地点,促销和包装其产品以塑造质量更高的形象。

6.4.3 Background Reading (相关背景阅读)

Price Competition

The most obvious, and often the most dangerous, form of competition is price competition. Many competitors make effective use of price competition. The stories of Ford, Apple Computer, Southwest Airlines, and Wal-Mart show how powerful this weapon can be. Note in all these examples demand is price elastic.

Price competition is dangerous, however, if demand is price inelastic. Cutting prices in a price-inelastic situation reduces total revenue. Thus, a firm that cuts its price can gain only by taking business away from its competitors and increasing its share of the market. But

if the competitors cut prices too, there may be no increase in any firm's market share.

Price competition is most effective and advisable if the firm doing the price cutting is also the low-cost producer. In that case, the competitors won't be able to match the price cuts and still stay in the business. A firm that wants to be the low-cost producer should be aware of two important economic concepts that govern costs of production. One is the concept of economies of scale. Often a firm can lower its average costs of production by increasing the size of its production facilities and its overall volume of production. It can offer volume discounts to its customers.

The second cost-related concept is the experience curve. Even without increasing the scale of operation, a firm can nevertheless lower costs as a result of increasing efficiencies gained from experience making the product. To take advantage of efficiencies, management has to deliberately try to learn how to cut costs as the company gains experience in producing the product.

参考译文

价格竞争

最明显但同时也是最危险的竞争形式是价格竞争。价格竞争对许多竞争者来说是非常有效的竞争手段。福特、苹果电脑、西南航空公司，以及沃尔玛成功的业绩显示了价格竞争是多么有力的竞争武器。但是请注意，在所有这些例子中，需求是有弹性的。

然而，如果需求不受价格影响，那么价格竞争就是危险的。在价格不影响需求的情形下，降价会减少总的收入，因此，采取降价策略的公司必须抢占其竞争者的业务以及提高市场份额才可以获得利润。但是，如果竞争者也降价，那么双方公司的市场份额都不会增加。

如果采取降价的公司生产成本较低，那么价格竞争手段是非常有效的，也是非常可取的。这样的话，竞争者为了不破产就无法采取相应的降价措施。如果一个公司想要成为生产成本很低的生产厂家，那么它必须知道两个很重要的影响生产成本的经济概念。一个是规模效益。通常公司通过提高生产规模和总的生产产量来降低平均生产成本。这样，如果顾客购买的产品数量较大，它就可以给顾客提供折扣。

另一个与成本有关的概念是经验曲线。即使没有提高生产经营的规模，公司通过提高效率也可以降低生产成本，效率的提高是因为在生产的过程中积累了经

验。为了充分发挥效率的作用，管理人员必须努力学会在公司积累了生产产品的经验后该如何降低成本。

6.4.4 Sample Test (□试样例)

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

- (1) What do you think is the most obvious competition?
你认为最明显的竞争形式是什么?
- (2) Do indirect competitors pose threats to a firm? (Why? /Why not?)
间接竞争者会对公司造成威胁吗? (为什么?)
- (3) Do you think it an effective way to meet and beat competition by increasing quality? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为提高产品质量是应对和赢得竞争有效的方法吗? (为什么?)
- (4) Do you think cutting price is the most effective way to meet competition? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为降价是应对竞争最有效的策略吗? (为什么?)

Suggested answers

(1) It's the direct competition, that is competition among firms that sell the same goods and services and compete for the same customers.

(2) Yes, they represent serious potential threats. Though they sell different goods and services, they sell to the same customers as your business. In some cases, the firm's indirect competitors sell a substitute product or service, so you may lose much of your business to them.

(3) Yes, because it is difficult for a competitor to match another firm's quality. If the firm can establish a quality advantage, it can raise its price and earn a higher profit.

(Yes, consumers are willing to pay more for better quality.)

(4) Yes, usually customers are price sensitive. By cutting prices, you can greatly increase sales and take your competitors' business away.

(No, because your competitors may cut prices too. In doing so, you may not increase your market share.

No, because if your firm is not a low-cost producer, you can't make profits by cutting prices.)

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What is important when ... ?

应对竞争时要注意什么要点?

Dealing with competition

- pricing policies
- advertising strategies
-

- 价格策略
- 广告策略
-

Suggested answer

Pricing policies are important because price is a very powerful weapon in dealing with competition. Price is a very important factor in consumers' buying decisions. Firms may set prices equal or lower than competitors' prices, so that they can attract customers, thus boosting sales and taking a large market share.

Advertising strategies are also important. Advertising can increase brand awareness. Once consumers have seen a product advertised either on TV, the Internet, or in newspapers, magazines, etc., they may tend to buy it.

In addition, quality is also important. A firm differentiates itself through the quality of its products. Not all buyers base their buying decisions on prices. They are willing to pay a higher price for better quality.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Dealing with Competition

You work in a car manufacturing company. You have been asked by your manager to help design the competition strategies. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what should be the pricing strategies
- what should be the quality and service strategies

应对竞争

你们在一家汽车制造公司工作。经理请你们帮助设计竞争策略。讨论并决定:

- 应采取什么价格策略
- 应采取什么质量和服务策略

Suggested answer

A: Nowadays, there is a severe competition among car manufacturing companies. In order to survive in the competition, I think our company should cut the prices of our cars.

B: Yes, I think so. If we cut the prices, many people will afford a car, and of

course, we can increase our sales.

- A: That's right. But we must ensure that we have increased the scale of production and that the costs of production are low, otherwise we'll reduce revenue.
- B: Other car companies will do the same, too. So, I think cutting prices is not enough. We should produce cars which are of high quality, then customers will be attracted by our cars.
- A: Yes. And I also think that we should offer customers some services that other car companies don't offer, for example, free car cleaning within 3 months of purchase.
- B: That sounds good. We can also compete by making some changes of the exterior looks of our car to make it more fashionable or sporty. Many people base their buying decisions just on the styles of cars.
- A: We can also develop some new and smaller cars. Because of limited space in cities, nowadays, people prefer small cars, but these small cars must be of superior quality.
- B: Or we can make some innovations to our present cars to cater for the tastes and needs of customers.
- A: OK, we can compete by cutting prices and making some innovations to cars.
- B: And by developing new cars and offering extra services.

Follow-up questions

- (1) Will you compete by offering extra services to customers? (Why? /Why not?)
你会通过给顾客提供更多的服务来参与竞争吗? (为什么?)
- (2) Do you think it a good way of competing by developing new and improved products or services? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为开发新产品或服务是参与竞争的好方法吗? (为什么?)
- (3) What would you do in the selling effort sector in order to compete?
你会在销售方面做什么努力以应对竞争?
- (4) Do you think location is important for retail businesses to compete? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为零售商店所处的位置对应对竞争很重要吗? (为什么?)
- (5) What do you think a company can do to lower its average costs?
你认为公司可以采取什么措施来降低平均成本?

Suggested answers

(1) Yes, I will, because a firm can also differentiate itself through extra services it offers to customers. Superior services can attract customers.

(2) Yes, I think it is a good way. Innovation is a key to success for some firms. Motorola is a typical example.

(No, I don't think so. Developing new or improved products is a costly process, and your products may not turn out to be successful.)

(3) I will use advertising, training the sales force and all the related activities to ensure that my firm has the superior sales techniques.

(4) I think location is particularly important for retail businesses. Shoppers are naturally drawn to some locations but find it hard to go to others. A retail store in a place that shoppers think is out of the way will not last long.

(5) By increasing the size of its production facilities and its overall volume of production, or by increasing efficiencies gained from experience of making the product.
